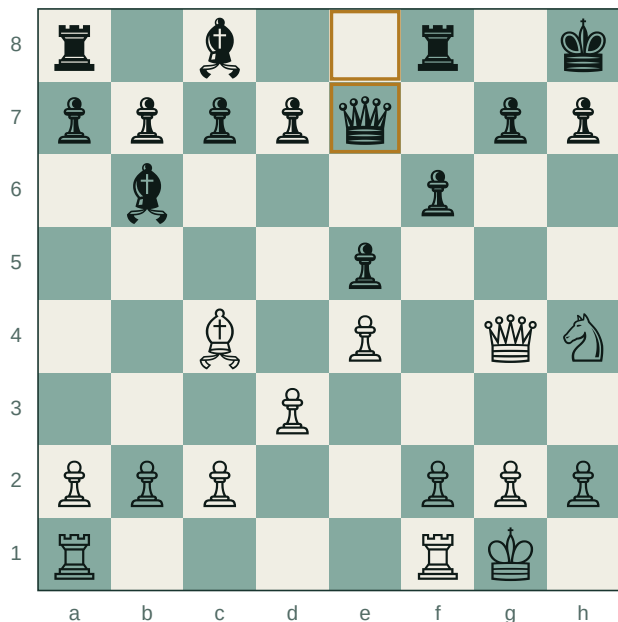


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 14

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 13...Qxe7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

14. Ng6+ hxg6 15. Qh3#

14.Ng6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g6 it attacks king on h8, queen on e7 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **14...hxg6**.

15.Qh3# Mate: queen on h3 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on e7. Check for tactical protection.